



2023

TRIAL HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

DO NOT REMOVE PAPER FROM EXAMINATION ROOM

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Centre Number

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Student Number

English Extension 1

Afternoon Session
Wednesday, 9 August 2023

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black pen
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page

**Total marks:
50****Section I – 25 marks** (pages 2–4)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 5–9)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2 (a) – 2 (e)
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

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Section I – Common Module: Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
-

Question 1 (25 marks)

Carefully read Texts 1 and 2 in order to answer Question 1 on page 4.

**Text 1 – *Creative Cities* by David Yencken – extract from Part 1, nonfiction book:
Space, Place & Culture, Helen Sykes (ed.)**

The city is an extraordinarily complex system. Even if we can't fully grasp it, even if we are bound to simplify, we must hold on to that complexity, for it is complexity that gives cities richness, vitality, and, significantly, health. In the same way that ecological variety and complexity give health to natural systems, so variety and complexity give health to social and cultural systems. People in different material circumstances, from different cultural backgrounds, of different ages, or of different temperaments, have different social and cultural needs. We cannot possibly envisage all these needs. They can only be expressed individually and satisfied by a myriad of different responses to them.

Question 1 continues on page 3

Question 1 (continued)

Text 2 – Excerpt from the novel *Istanbul: Memories of a City* by Orhan Pamuk

Here we come to the heart of the matter: I've never left Istanbul – never left the houses, streets and neighbourhoods of my childhood. Although I've lived in other districts from time to time, fifty years on I find myself back in the Pamuk Apartments, where my first photographs were taken and where my mother first held me in her arms to show me the world. I know this persistence owes something to my imaginary friend, and to the solace I took from the bond between us. But we live in an age defined by mass migration and creative immigrants, and so I am sometimes hard-pressed to explain why I've stayed not only in the same place, but the same building. My mother's sorrowful voice comes back to me, 'Why don't you go outside for a while, why don't you try a change of scene, do some travelling ...?'

Conrad, Nabokov, Naipaul – these are writers known for having managed to migrate between languages, cultures, countries, continents, even civilisations. Their imaginations were fed by exile, a nourishment drawn not through roots but through rootlessness; mine, however, requires that I stay in the same city, on the same street, in the same house, gazing at the same view. Istanbul's fate is my fate: I am attached to this city because it has made me who I am.

Flaubert, who visited Istanbul a hundred and two years before my birth, was struck by the variety of life in its teeming streets; in one of his letters, he predicted that in a century's time it would be the capital of the world. The reverse came true: after the Ottoman Empire collapsed, the world almost forgot that Istanbul existed. The city into which I was born was poorer, shabbier, and more isolated than it had ever been in its two-thousand-year history. For me it has always been a city of ruins and of end-of-empire melancholy. I've spent my life either battling with this melancholy, or (like all Istanbulites) making it my own.

At least once in a lifetime, self-reflection leads us to examine the circumstances of our birth. Why were we born in this particular corner of the world, on this particular date? These families into which we were born, these countries and cities to which the lottery of life has assigned us – they expect love from us, and in the end, we do love them, from the bottom of our hearts – but did we perhaps deserve better? I sometimes think myself unlucky to have been born in an ageing and impoverished city buried under the ashes of a ruined empire. But a voice inside me always insists this was really a piece of luck. If it were a matter of wealth, then I could certainly count myself fortunate to have been born into an affluent family at a time when the city was at its lowest ebb (though some have ably argued the contrary). Mostly I am disinclined to complain: I've accepted the city into which I was born in the same way I've accepted my body (much as I would have preferred to be more handsome and better built) and my gender (even though I still ask myself, naively, whether I might have been better off had I been born a woman). This is my fate, and there's sense arguing with it. This book is about fate

...

Question 1 continues on page 4

Question 1 (continued)

Question 1 (25 marks)

Literary worlds allow writers to represent the complex relationship between character and setting.

Using Texts 1 and 2 to inspire your writing, construct a literary world in which a character is impacted by the complexities of a city.

Section II – Electives

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2 (a) to 2 (e)

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
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Question 2 (a) – Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 marks)

Literature is a unique form of memory. It rejects, alters, exaggerates and glorifies. It creates its own reality to provoke alternative ways of connecting.

Evaluate how this statement is realised in the texts you have studied in Literary Homelands.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for elective Literary Homelands are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
 - E. M. Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - Colm Tóibín, *Brooklyn*
- **Poetry**
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*
 - The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Burning Rice*
 - * *Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
 - * *My Hakka Grandmother*
 - * *Shophouse, Victoria Street*
 - * *Chinese Ginseng*
 - * *Winter Meeting*
 - * *Singapore*
- **Drama**
 - Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville – An adaptation for the stage by Andrew Bovell]
- **Film**
 - Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

OR

Question 2 (b) – Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval (25 marks)

Literature is a unique form of memory. It rejects, alters, exaggerates and glorifies. It creates its own reality to provoke alternative ways of being.

Evaluate how this statement is realised in the texts you have studied in Worlds of Upheaval.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for the elective Worlds of Upheaval are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*
- **Poetry**
 - Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966–1996*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Digging*
 - * *The Strand at Lough Beg*
 - * *Casualty*
 - * *Funeral Rites*
 - * from *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
 - * *Triptych*
- **Drama**
 - Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*
- **Film**
 - Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

OR

Question 2 (c) – Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 marks)

Literature is a unique form of memory. It rejects, alters, exaggerates and glorifies. It creates its own reality to provoke alternative ways of perceiving.

Evaluate how this statement is realised in the texts you have studied in Reimagined Worlds.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for the elective Reimagined Worlds are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter's Night a Traveller*
 - Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
 - Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver's Travels*
- **Poetry**
 - Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
 - * *The Eolian Harp*
 - * *Kubla Khan*
 - * *Christabel*
 - Tracy K. Smith, *Life on Mars*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Sci-Fi*
 - * *My God, It's Full of Stars*
 - * *Don't You Wonder, Sometimes?*
 - * *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
 - * *The Universe as Primal Scream*
- **Film**
 - Guillermo Del Toro, *Pan's Labyrinth*

OR

Question 2 (d) – Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes (25 marks)

Literature is a unique form of memory. It rejects, alters, exaggerates and glorifies. It creates its own reality to provoke alternative ways of thinking.

Evaluate how this statement is realised in the texts you have studied in Literary Mindscapes.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for the elective Literary Mindscapes are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - William Faulkner, *As I Lay Dying*
 - Gail Jones, *Sixty Lights*
 - Katherine Mansfield, *The Collected Stories*
 - * *Prelude*
 - * *Je ne Parle pas Français*
 - * *Bliss*
 - * *Psychology*
 - * *The Daughters of the Late Colonel*
- **Poetry**
 - Emily Dickinson, *The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *I felt a Funeral, in my Brain*
 - * *This is my letter to the World*
 - * *I died for Beauty – but was scarce*
 - * *I had been hungry, all the Years*
 - * *Because I could not stop for Death*
 - * *My Life has stood – a Loaded Gun*
 - * *A word dropped careless on a Page*
- **Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *Hamlet*
- **Film**
 - Sofia Coppola, *Lost in Translation*

OR

Question 2 (e) – Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds (25 marks)

Literature is a unique form of memory. It eliminates, alters, exaggerates and glorifies. It creates its own reality to provoke alternative ways of relating with the natural world.

Evaluate how this statement is realised in the texts you have studied in Intersecting Worlds.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for the elective Intersecting Worlds are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
 - Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
 - Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*
- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *Island Home*
- **Poetry**
 - William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
 - * *Three years she grew in sun and shower*
 - * *My heart leaps up when I behold*
 - * *Resolution and Independence*
 - * *The world is too much with us*
 - * *Ode ('There was a time')*
 - * *The Solitary Reaper*
 - * *The Prelude (1805)* – Book One, lines 1–67, 271–441
- **Film**
 - Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*

End of Examination

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Question 1 Text 1	Yencken, David (2013). <i>Creative Cities</i> . Published in <i>Space, place & culture</i> / edited by Helen Sykes Future Leaders. Used with permission.
Question 1 Text 2	Orhan Pamuk (2006). <i>Istanbul: memories and the city</i> . Faber and Faber Ltd. Used with permission.
Question 2 Elective 1 – 6	Quotation created by the 2023 CSSA Trial HSC Examination English Extension 1 – Committee.

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